

MIL-STD-29A

1 March 1962

SUPERSEDING

MIL-STD-29

23 September 1958

MILITARY STANDARD
SPRINGS, MECHANICAL;
DRAWING REQUIREMENTS FOR

APPENDIX OF REFERENCES TO
MATERIALS, DESIGN FORMULAS,
PROCESSES AND TOLERANCES
FOR MECHANICAL SPRINGS

(APPENDIX INCLUDES NO MANDATORY PROVISIONS)

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Springs, Mechanical; Drawing Requirements for
MIL-STD-29A
1 March 1962

1. This standard has been approved by the Department of Defense and is mandatory for use by the Departments of the Army, the Navy and the Air Force.
2. In accordance with established procedures, the Ordnance Corps, Bureau of Naval Weapons and the Air Force, have been designated as Army-Navy-Air Force custodians of this standard.
3. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to the Standardization Division, Defense Supply Agency, Washington 25, D.C.

1. Scope

1.1 Scope

This standard illustrates the approved method of drawing, dimensioning, and specifying spring data on detail drawings of each type of mechanical spring described herein. Adherence to this standard is mandatory in the preparation of drawings prepared by or for the Department of Defense. Appendix A contains material, design and manufacturing data representative of modern spring engineering. It is included herein for guidance and convenience only and contains no mandatory provisions.

1.1.1 Types of Springs

The types of springs described in this standard are:

1.1.1.1 Compression (a) Helical, Cylindrical; (b) Helical, Stranded Wire; (c) Volute; (d) Coned Disc (Belleville)

1.1.1.2 Extension (a) Helical

1.1.1.3 Torsion (a) Helical; (b) Volute; (c) Spiral

1.1.1.4 Flat (a) Cantilever

1.1.1.5 Constant Force (a) Flat Strip

1.1.1.6 Garter (a) Helical

1.2 Purpose

The purpose of this standard is to establish uniform methods of specifying end product data for mechanical springs on drawings prepared by or for the Department of Defense.

2. Referenced Documents

2.1 Not Applicable

3. Definitions

3.1 Mechanical Spring

An elastic body whose mechanical function is to store energy when deflected under load and return the equivalent amount of energy upon being released.

3.2 Load

The force exerted upon or by a spring in order to reproduce or modify motion or to maintain a force system in equilibrium. A static load is slowly applied and does not subject a spring to fatigue. A dynamic load is either a suddenly applied load or one that causes impact due to kinetic energy. It also may be frequently repeated, thus shortening fatigue life.

3.3 Total Deflection

The movement of a spring from free position to its maximum operating position. In a compression spring, it is the deflection from the Free Length to the Solid Length.

3.4 Deflection per Coil

The total deflection of the spring divided by the number of active coils.

3.5 Set

The permanent distortion from the manufactured dimensions which occurs when the spring is stressed beyond the elastic limit of the material.

3.6 Active Coils

The number of coils which are used in computing the total deflection of the spring.

3.7 Total Coils

The number of active coils plus the coils forming the ends, (Compression Springs).

3.8 Solid Length

The overall length of a compression spring when all coils are fully compressed.

3.9 Free Length

The overall length of a spring in the unloaded position.

3.10 Pitch

The distance between centers of adjacent active coils of a spring in the unloaded position.

3.11 Initial Tension

A load wound into certain helical extension springs during the coiling operation which keeps the coils tightly closed and which must be exceeded by an applied load before the coils begin to open.

3.12 Spring Index

The ratio of the mean spring diameter to the diameter of the wire.

3.13 Spring Rate

The load required to deflect a compression or extension spring one inch or the load required to deflect a torsion spring one degree or one revolution. Also referred to as "Scale," "Gradient" and "Load Factor."

3.14 Torque

A turning force about an axis multiplied by the distance from the load to the axis, usually expressed in pound-inches (LB IN.) or in ounce-inches (OZ IN.) and always used in conjunction with the number of degrees of rotation, number of revolutions or deflected position.

3.15 Spring Tolerance

The permissible variations from a given dimension.

3.16 Factor of Safety

The ratio of the maximum load a spring can sustain without permanent set to the maximum applied load.

3.17 Direction of Helix

When a spring is viewed from one end, the direction of helix is right hand when the coil recedes in a clockwise direction, and left hand when it recedes in a counterclockwise direction. A right hand helix follows the same direction as the threads on a standard screw. A left hand helix is most popular for compression and extension springs.

3.18 Reference Dimension

A reference dimension is a dimension without tolerance which is entered on a drawing for informational purposes and which does not directly govern manufacturing or inspection operations. Reference dimensions are indicated on drawings by writing the abbreviation REF directly following or under the dimension.

3.19 Stress Relieve

To subject springs to a low temperature heat treatment after coiling or bending to remove residual stresses caused by the forming operation. Also called "strain relieve", "stress equalizing", "tempering", "blueing" and "baking".

3.20 Range of Stress

The difference between the stress at maximum and minimum loads.

3.21 Harden

To cause a material to become harder by heat treatment. Spring steels are heated above the critical temperature and quenched in oil. Precipitation hardening alloys such as Beryllium-Copper, K-Monel and Inconel X are heated at elevated temperatures for extended periods of time.

3.22 Endurance Limit

The maximum stress range of stress at which a material will operate indefinitely without failure. This limit for springs is usually determined at 10,000,000 cycles of deflection.

3.23 Elastic Limit

The maximum stress to which a material may be subjected without causing a permanent set. Also the stress beyond which a material must be subjected to form a coil, radius or bend.

3.24 Modulus of Rigidity

The measure of elastic ability. A mathematical constant expressing the stiffness, rigidity, elasticity and flexibility of a material. Also called "modulus of elasticity" and "Young modulus".

4. General Requirements

4.1 Not Applicable

5. Detail Requirements

5.1 General

Figures 2(a) through 2(d), 4(a) through 4(d), 7, 10, 12, 13, 14, 16, 17 and 18 are Drawing Requirement Charts illustrating approved methods of drawing and dimensioning the various types of springs listed in paragraph 1.1.1 and include compilations of spring data to be used as applicable when prescribing manufacturing information on detail drawings of mechanical springs. The inclusion herein of these charts should not be interpreted as restricting the scope of spring characteristics to be specified on engineering drawings delineating springs. The specification of correct and complete manufacturing data is the responsibility of the cognizant Design Activity. Figures 19 thru 30 are examples of typical detail drawings of springs illustrating the application of the information included on the charts.

5.1.1 Delineation

The simplified drafting methods shown on the Drawing Requirement Charts and the typical detail drawings, e.g., Figures 2(a) and 19, are generally satisfactory for depicting helical springs.

5.2 Specifications Applicable to All Springs

5.2.1 Material Specifications

Material specifications are designated in the space provided in the title block on the drawing. When such space is inadequate enter therein "SEE NOTE" and describe the material requirements in a general note.

5.2.2 Diameter of Wire

Wire diameter, or width or thickness of material, shall be designated in decimals, or common fractions of an inch, as applicable, and unless otherwise specified, all dimensions apply before plating or applying finishes. Such dimensions are used to avoid confusion resulting from various gage numbering systems in current use. However, they should conform with the appropriate gage customarily used with the material specified, whenever possible. For oil tempered and corrosion resisting steels such diameters should conform with the U. S. Steel Wire Gage, which is the same as the Washburn & Moen Gage. For non-ferrous materials the American Wire Gage, which is the same as the Brown & Sharpe Gage, is used. Music Wire is drawn to the American Steel Wire and Music Wire Gage but other gages and intermediate sizes are available. Do not specify the name of the Gage used. Tolerances on diameter and thickness shall not be specified when they are covered in the appropriate material specifications or by general tolerance notes. Specify a tolerance on the width, as applicable. See Table I, Preferred Sizes of Spring Materials, in Appendix A, Section I.

5.2.3 Inspection Notes

Detail drawings of springs that are critical, including those springs subjected to critical conditions of temperature, stress or corrosive environments, shall include appropriate instruction notes applicable to controlling the manufacture within the desired environments. It is appropriate to specify those spring factors requiring inspection, the tests required, and whether all springs produced from the particular drawing shall be inspected. Consistent with Quality Control Procedure the size of inspection samples shall not be specified.

5.3 Format for Special Data Notes

When notes prescribing special data are required on detail drawings of springs, it is recommended that the following format be used:

- (a) Stress at ... F +/- ... F for ... minutes, after coiling (or forming)
- (b) Hardness range Rc ... to ...
- (c) Squareness of ends in free position within ... degrees

- (d) Cold set to solid.
- (e) Shot peen (give specification) to ... intensity.
- (f) Protective coating (give specification).
- (g) Non destructive inspection (give specification).
- (h) The body shall not camber more than ... IN. in its entire length
- (i) Test over arbor dia ... IN.
- (j) To withstand temperatures of ... F for ... hours with loss of load not to exceed ... %.
- (k) To withstand ... deflections from initial to final position with loss of load not to exceed ... %.

5.4 Helical Compression Springs

5.4.1 Definition

A compression spring is an open-coil helical spring that offers resistance to a compressive force applied axially. Compression springs are generally made cylindrical in form, although other forms are used, such as conical, tapered, concave or convex, consistent with design requirements. Because of ready supply, wire of circular cross section is used whenever possible; however, where advantageous to design, wire of square or rectangular cross section may be utilized. Figure 1 illustrates several forms of helical compression springs.

5.4.2 Drawing Requirements

Guide lines for specifying pertinent dimensional and load data on engineering drawings of helical compression springs, which satisfy specific design requirements and, simultaneously, allow maximum latitude in manufacturing, are provided herein, categorized as follows:

(1) No Load Specified.

The design activity assumes responsibility for the load capacity of the spring. The manufacturer is required to furnish a spring meeting the dimensional data specified. The free length, the coil diameter, and the total number of coils are specified, each with a tolerance. The tolerance on the wire diameter conforms to the governing material specification. Figure 2(a) shows suggested data applicable to springs in the "no load" category.

(2) One Load Specified.

This category has application when the spring is required to develop a load, within a specified tolerance, preferably at the initial assembled length. The spring, normally, is not subjected to further deflection in operation. The manufacturer is required to meet the load requirement, but the free length and the total number of coils are not restricted, being designated REF. The tolerance on the wire diameter conforms to the governing material specification and the manner of coil diameter callout is dependent upon spring function. Figure 2(b) shows suggested data applicable to springs in the "one load" category.

(3) Two Loads Specified.

This category has application when the spring is required to develop a load within a specified tolerance, at each of two definite compressed lengths, normally at the initial and the final operating positions in the assembly. The manufacturer is required to meet the

load requirements, other spring characteristics being designated as described in paragraph 5.4.2 (2). Figure 2(c) shows suggested data applicable to springs in the "two loads" category.

(4) **Spring Rate Specified.**

This category has application in assemblies in which the spring rate is the most significant characteristic, for example, in calibrated scales. The manufacturer is required to meet a prescribed spring rate, within a specified tolerance, but the free length and the total number of coils are permitted to vary, being designated REF. The tolerance on the wire diameter conforms to the governing material specification and the manner of coil diameter callout is dependent upon the spring function. Additionally, when closer control of the load to be developed at the initial assembled length is desired, one load, with a tolerance, to be developed at the assembled length should be specified. Figure 2(d) shows suggested data applicable to springs in the "spring rate" category.

5.4.2.1 Coil Diameter Depending upon the application of the spring, specify one of the following:

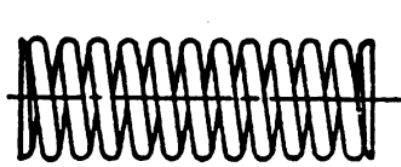
- (a) TO WORK OVER...IN. (MAX) DIA ROD
- (b) TO WORK IN...IN. (MIN) DIA BORE
- (c) ID, with tolerance
- (d) OD, with tolerance

5.4.2.2 Direction of Helix When governed by design requirements, specify the direction of helix as "LEFT HAND" (or LH), or "RIGHT HAND" (or RH), as applicable; otherwise specify as OPTIONAL. In most cases the hand is not important except when a plug screws into an end; or when one spring fits inside another, in which case one spring should be designated left hand and the other right hand.

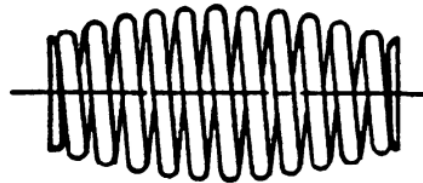
5.4.2.3 Type of Ends The types of ends having application to helical compression springs are illustrated in Figure 3. Specify the type of ends on the drawing; when necessary, the ends should be dimensioned.

5.4.2.4 Solid Length The maximum solid length shall be specified for any spring category when this parameter is essential to design requirements. However, solid length callout should be omitted whenever practicable. Except when necessary to satisfy function, springs should not be designed to go solid in operation.

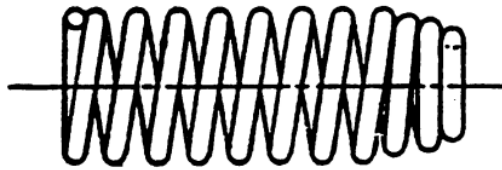
HELICAL COMPRESSION SPRING FORMS



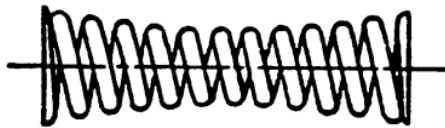
CYLINDRICAL
RIGHT HAND HELIX



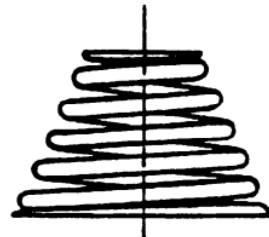
CONVEX
RIGHT HAND HELIX



CYLINDRICAL WITH CONED END
LEFT HAND HELIX



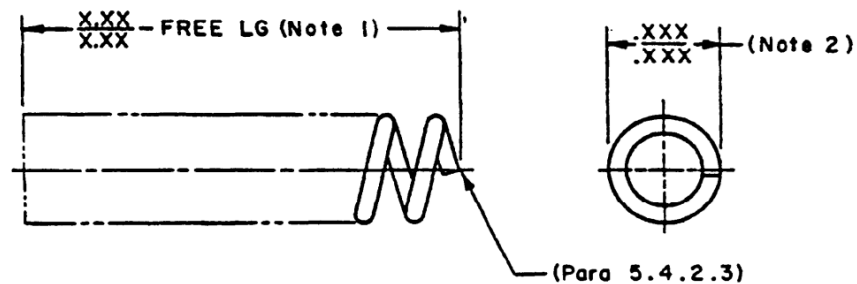
CONCAVE
RIGHT HAND HELIX



CONICAL
RIGHT HAND HELIX

Figure 1: Helical Compression Spring Forms

DRAWING REQUIREMENTS FOR HELICAL COMPRESSION SPRINGS
WHEN NO LOAD IS SPECIFIED



Spring data

	<i>Para</i>
MATERIAL SPECIFICATION	5.2.1
WIRE DIA $\frac{XXX}{XXX}$ IN.	5.2.2
DIRECTION OF HELIX	5.4.2.2
TOTAL COILS $XX \pm XX$	Note 3
SPECIAL DATA	5.3

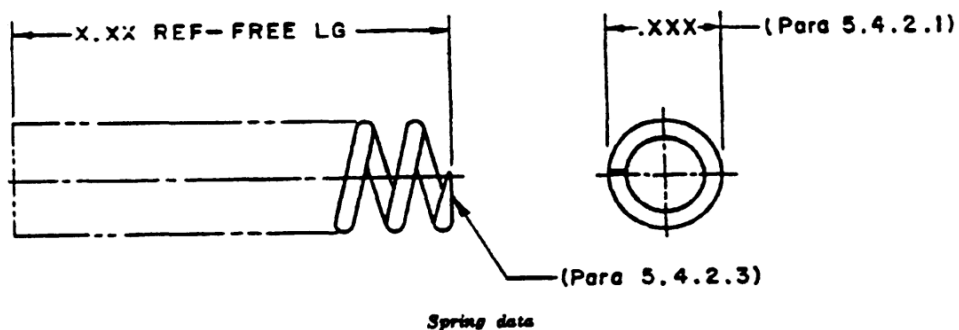
Note 1: Specify free length, with tolerance (or by limits). (Refer to Appendix A, Section III, Table XIX.)

Note 2: When spring operates over guide, specify inside diameter of coil, with tolerance (or by limits). For other applications, specify outside diameter with tolerance (or by limits). (Refer to Appendix A, Section III, Table XVI.)

Note 3: Specify total number of coils, with tolerance. (Refer to Appendix A, Section III, Table XVII.)

Figure 2:

DRAWING REQUIREMENTS FOR HELICAL COMPRESSION SPRINGS
WHEN ONE LOAD IS SPECIFIED



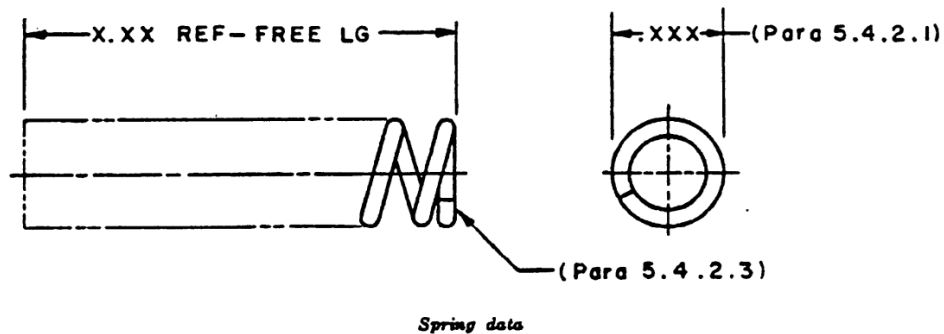
	Para
MATERIAL SPECIFICATION	5.2.1
WIRE DIAXXX IN.	5.2.2
DIRECTION OF HELIX	5.4.2.2
TOTAL COILS XX REF	Note 1
LOAD AT COMPRESSED LG OF XXX IN. - XX LB ± XX LB	Note 2
SPECIAL DATA	5.3

Note 1: Specify total number of coils; designate REF.

Note 2: Specify the *one load*, with tolerance, to be developed at a definite length, preferably the initial assembled length.

Figure 3:

DRAWING REQUIREMENTS FOR HELICAL COMPRESSION SPRINGS
WHEN TWO LOADS ARE SPECIFIED



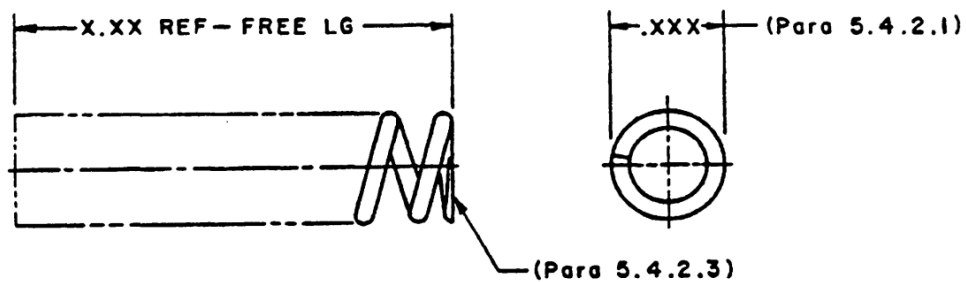
	<i>Para</i>
MATERIAL SPECIFICATION	5.2.1
WIRE DIA XXX IN.	5.2.2
DIRECTION OF HELIX	5.4.2.2
TOTAL COILS XX REF	Note 1
LOAD AT COMPRESSED LG OF XXX IN - XX LB ± XX LB	Note 2
LOAD AT COMPRESSED LG OF XXX IN - XX LB ± XX LB	Note 2
SPECIAL DATA	5.3

Note 1: Specify total number of coils; designate REF.

Note 2: Specify load to be developed at each of two definite compressed lengths, preferably at the initial and the final operating positions in the assembly.

Figure 4:

DRAWING REQUIREMENTS FOR HELICAL COMPRESSION SPRINGS
WHEN SPRING RATE IS SPECIFIED



Spring data

	Para
MATERIAL SPECIFICATION	5.2.1
WIRE DIAXXX IN.	5.2.2
DIRECTION OF HELIX	5.4.2.2
TOTAL COILS XX REF	Note 1
LOAD AT COMPRESSED LG OF .XXX IN. - XX LB ± XX LB	5.4.2(4)
SPRING RATE XX LB/IN. ± XX LB/IN. BETWEEN COMPRESSED LG OF XX IN. AND XX IN.	Note 2
SOLID LG WITHOUT PERMANENT SET XX IN.	5.4.2.4
SPECIAL DATA	5.3

Note 1: Specify total number of coils; designate REF.

Note 2: Specify spring rate, with tolerance.

Figure 5:

5.5 Stranded Wire Compression Springs

5.5.1 Definition

Stranded wire compression springs are helical compression springs formed from two, three, or more wires twisted about each other, or about one wire as a core, to form a single strand. Stranded wire compression springs have the advantage of damping the migratory waves that traverse the spring under shock loading. Such springs should be specified with caution since stranded wire is specially made and is not readily available.

5.5.2 Drawing Requirements

Figure 20 is a typical detail drawing of a stranded wire helical compression spring. The methods of drawing and dimensioning, and the spring data applicable to stranded wire spring correspond in general to those shown in Figures 2(c) for compression springs, except that the additional spring information noted herein is required on detail drawings:

- (a) Number of Wires in Strand.
- (b) Diameter of each Wire.
- (c) Length of Lay (Distance parallel to strand axis in which a single wire makes one turn.)
- (d) Direction of strand helix. NOTE: The strand helix shall be opposite in turn to the coil helix.
- (e) Direction of coil helix (Left Hand or Right Hand).
- (f) Type of Ends. Specify either Closed Ends Not Ground or Open Ends Not Ground, as applicable. Specify that ends are to be soldered, brazed, or welded to prevent unraveling, and sharp burrs shall be removed.

5.6 Helical Extension Springs

5.6.1 Definition

A helical extension spring is a close-wound spring with or without initial tension, or an open-wound spring

(yet to be transcribed)

5.6.2 Drawing Requirements for Helical Extension Springs

(yet to be transcribed)

5.6.2.1 Total Coils and Length Over Coils (yet to be transcribed)

5.6.2.2 Maximum Extended Length (yet to be transcribed)

5.6.2.3 Types of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.6.2.4 Relative Position of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.7 Helical Torsion Springs

5.7.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.1 Total Coils and Length Over Coils (yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.2 Direction of Helix (yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.3 Pitch of Coils or Initial Tension (yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.4 Torque Loads (yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.5 Maximum Deflection without Permanent Set (yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.6 Spring Rate (yet to be transcribed)

5.7.2.7 Type of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.8 Spiral Torsion Springs

5.8.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.8.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.8.2.1 Outside and Inside Diameter of Coil (yet to be transcribed)

5.8.2.2 Developed Length of Material and Active Length of Material (yet to be transcribed)

5.8.2.3 Number of Coils in Free Position (yet to be transcribed)

5.8.2.4 Type of Ends and Angular Relation of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.9 Torsion Bar Springs

5.9.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.1 Diameter of Body and Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.2 Length Overall and of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.3 Angle of Taper (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.4 Torque Loads (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.5 Spring Rate (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.6 Type of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.7 Direction of Windup Marking (yet to be transcribed)

5.9.2.8 Angular Relation between Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.10 Volute Springs

5.10.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.1 Outside and Inside Diameter (yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.2 Free Length (yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.3 Total Coils (yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.4 Radial Pitch (yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.5 Axial Pitch and Helix Angle (yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.6 Loads (yet to be transcribed)

5.10.2.7 Solid Length (yet to be transcribed)

5.11 Coned Disc Belleville Springs

5.11.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2.1 Inside and Outside Diameters (yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2.2 Free Height and Method of Stacking (yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2.3 Loads (yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2.4 Bearing Surfaces (yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2.5 Bearing Surfaces Parallel (yet to be transcribed)

5.11.2.6 Concentricity between Diameters (yet to be transcribed)

5.12 Flat Springs

(yet to be transcribed)

5.12.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.12.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.12.2.1 Developed Lengths (yet to be transcribed)

5.12.2.2 Clamp Length (yet to be transcribed)

5.12.2.3 Loads (yet to be transcribed)

5.13 Constant Force Springs

(yet to be transcribed)

5.13.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.13.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.13.2.1 Loads (yet to be transcribed)

5.13.2.2 Initial Position and Final Position (yet to be transcribed)

5.13.2.3 Type of Ends (yet to be transcribed)

5.13.2.4 Fits Over Roller (yet to be transcribed)

5.13.2.5 Thickness (yet to be transcribed)

5.14 Garter Springs

(yet to be transcribed)

5.14.1 Definition

(yet to be transcribed)

5.14.2 Drawing Requirements

(yet to be transcribed)

5.14.2.1 Shaft Diameter (yet to be transcribed)

5.14.2.2 Compressive Load on Shaft (yet to be transcribed)

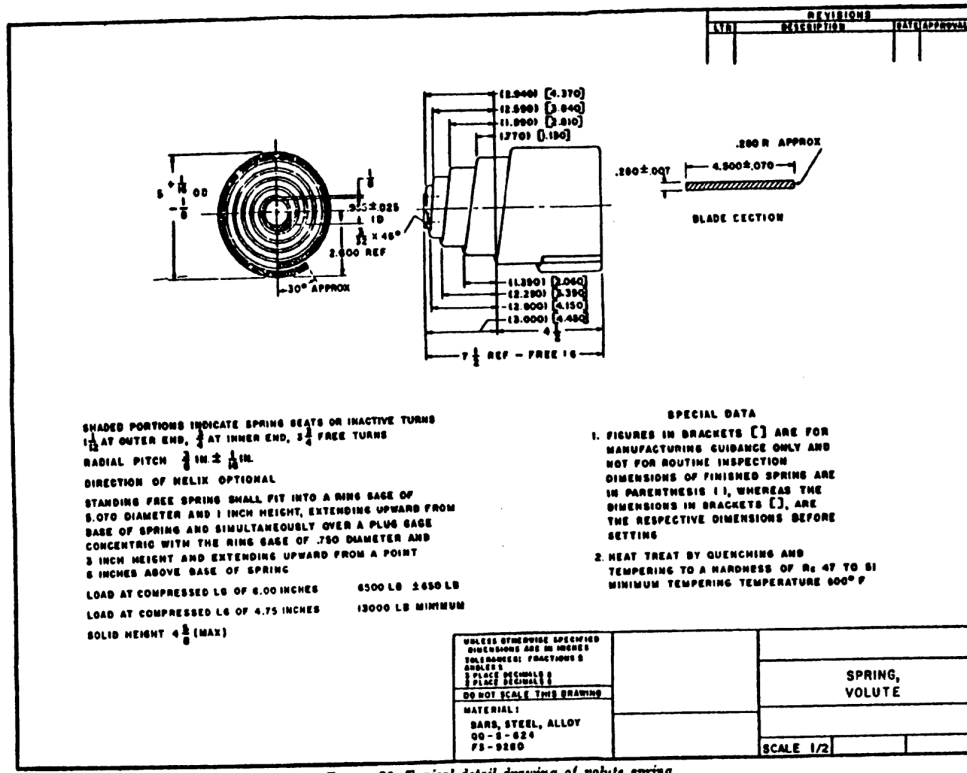


Figure 6:

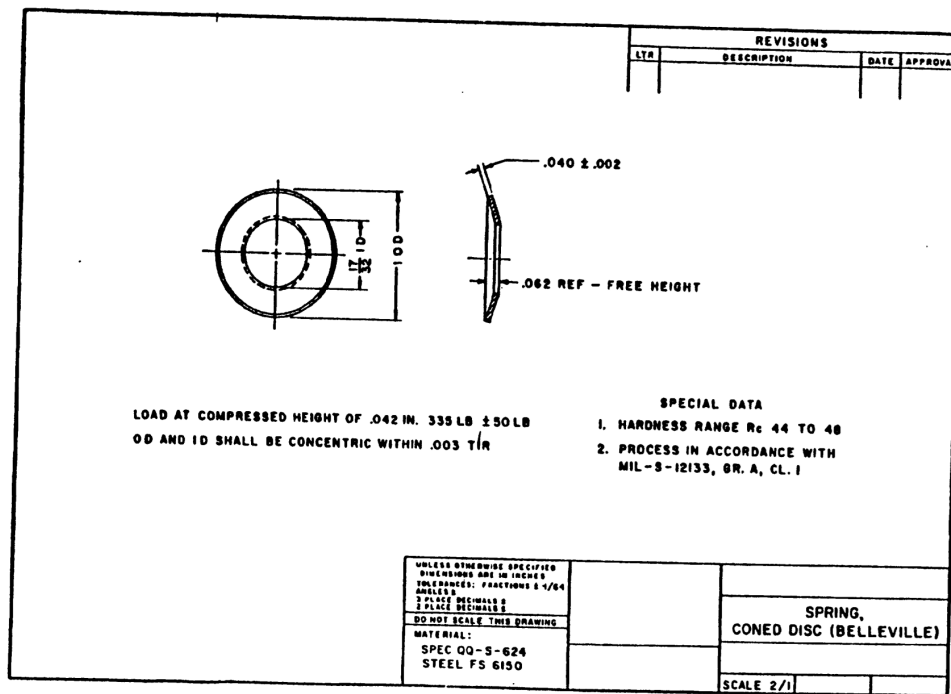


FIGURE 27. Typical detail drawing of coned disc (Belleville) spring

Figure 7:

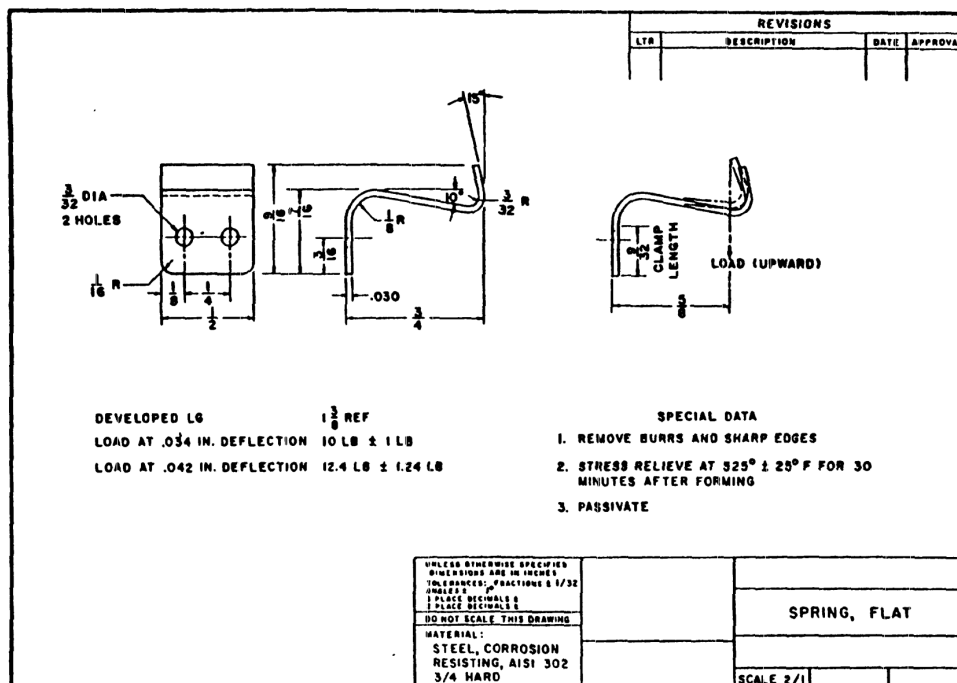


FIGURE 28. Typical detail drawing of flat spring

Figure 8:

Appendix A

THIS APPENDIX IS FOR THE PURPOSE OF PROVIDING GUIDANCE TO DESIGN ENGINEERS AND INCLUDES NO MANDATORY PROVISIONS.

10. Design of Mechanical Springs

10.1 Purpose

The purpose of this appendix is to provide ready reference data to spring design information including data on materials, design, manufacturing processes and recommended tolerances. The information contained herein is intended to provide guidance to the designers of springs and not to impose restrictions in design.

10.2 Scope

The data contained in this appendix are sufficient for general spring design. This appendix is divided into three sections:

Section I— MATERIALS

Section II — DESIGN, and

Section III — MANUFACTURE.

Appendix A, Section I

11. Spring Materials

11.1 General

More than forty different steel compositions, seven corrosion resisting steels and about twenty different non-ferrous compositions are used as spring materials. Each has some particular advantage over the others and the selection is based on seeking, in addition to other requirements, the best behavior in applications involving high stress, shock loads, elevated temperatures and corrosion resistance. All spring wire should be used in round cross-section whenever possible as it is more readily available, less expensive, usually has higher mechanical properties and is easier to fabricate. Steel wire has the longest fatigue life and can withstand the highest stresses. Copper-base alloys have the best electrical conductivity combined with good corrosion resistance. Corrosion resisting steels have good resistance to moderately elevated temperatures and to corrosion. Nickel-base alloys have the best resistance to elevated temperatures combined with excellent corrosion resistance. More specific data on these materials is covered in this section. The SAE and AISI references and the specifications of bar in the following paragraphs represent typical compositions of metal from which springs with the specified mechanical properties can be produced.

11.2 Sizes Available

In the column headed Mechanical Properties in Paragraphs 12.2 through 17.3 are shown "Sizes Available", which lists the range of sizes usually available from warehouses or wire mills. For most materials both smaller and larger sizes can be obtained on special order. The sizes shown in Table I, Appendix A, Section I, should be used wherever possible.

12. High Carbon Steels

12.1 General

The most commonly used of all spring materials are the high carbon spring steels. These materials are used in Music-Wire, Hard-Drawn Wire, Oil Tempered Wire and Valve Spring Wire. All are readily available in a wide variety of sizes. These materials should be used in preference to other materials whenever the design requirements permit their use. They are not usually recommended for sub zero temperature applications.

12.2 Music Wire

(yet to be transcribed)

12.3 Hard Drawn

(yet to be transcribed)

12.4 Oil Tempered

(yet to be transcribed)

12.5 Carbon Steel Valve Spring Quality

(yet to be transcribed)

13. Alloy Steel Wire and BAR

13.1 General

Alloy spring steels are particularly useful in applications involving high stresses and where shock or impact loadings occur. They can also withstand higher and lower temperature conditions than the carbon spring Steels. All these alloys are generally used in the oil tempered or pre-hardened condition. They also are obtainable in the annealed condition for springs that have sharp bends or small spring indexes such as 5 or less.

13.2 Chrome-Vanadium

(yet to be transcribed)

13.3 Silico-Manganese

(yet to be transcribed)

13.4 Chrome-Silicon

This alloy steel is especially suited for highly stressed springs subjected to shock or impact loading such as recoil springs in anti-aircraft guns and for moderately elevated temperatures. It may be obtained in the oil-tempered condition, but has most often been used in the annealed condition and then hardened and tempered to quite high hardness after coiling.

14. Corrosion Resisting Steel Wire

14.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

14.2 Type FS302

(yet to be transcribed)

14.3 Type FS304

(yet to be transcribed)

14.4 Type FS316

(yet to be transcribed)

14.5 Type 17-7 PH

(yet to be transcribed)

14.6 Type FS420

(yet to be transcribed)

14.7 Type 481

(yet to be transcribed)

15. Copper Base Alloys

15.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

15.2 Spring Brass

(yet to be transcribed)

15.3 Phosphor Bronze

(yet to be transcribed)

15.4 Beryllium Copper

(yet to be transcribed)

16. Nickel Base Alloys

16.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

16.2 Monel

(yet to be transcribed)

16.3 K-Monel

(yet to be transcribed)

16.4 Inconel

(yet to be transcribed)

16.5 Inconel X

(yet to be transcribed)

17. Steel Strip High Carbon

17.1 General

Several types of flat cold rolled steel strip with different ranges of carbon content, tempers, finishes and edges are obtainable, but only two types are readily available. These two types are used for over 95 per cent of all applications requiring steel strip. Thin sections of high hardness (over Rockwell "C" 43) are highly susceptible to hydrogen embrittlement resulting from electroplating or pickling operations. These materials are used for main-springs in clocks and timing devices; for constant force springs, clips and stampings. For general information see Spec. MIL-S-17919.

17.2 SAE 1074

(yet to be transcribed)

17.3 SAE 1095

(yet to be transcribed)

Table I. Preferred sizes for spring materials wire diameters, strip thickness and bars

Note 1. Square sizes of wire and bars are obtainable in preferred fractional sizes as follows: 1/32, 1/16, 3/32, 1/8, 5/32, 3/16, 7/32, 1/4, 9/32, 5/16, 3/8, 7/16, 1/2, 9/16, 5/8, 11/16, 3/4, 13/16, 7/8, 15/16, 1, 1 1/16, 1 1/8, 1 3/16, 1 1/4, 1 5/16, 1 3/8, 1 1/2, 1 5/8, 1 3/4, 1 7/8 and 2 in.

Note 2. Music wire and Valve spring quality wire are available in round sections only.

Note 3. Music wire is drawn to American Steel Wire & Music Wire Gage and to special gages. Steel wire is drawn to U.S. Steel Wire Gage (same as Washburn & Moen Gage). Copper and Nickel Alloys are drawn to the American Wire Gage (same as Brown & Sharpe Gage).

Appendix A, Section II

20. Spring Design

20.1 General

The proper design of springs requires an understanding of

- 1 - spring materials,
- 2 - design formulas and stress analysis,
- 3 - manufacture.

Various aids to designers are available including special spring slide rules, tables of constants, curves, charts and nomographs. All are helpful, but an understanding of the basic fundamental formulas and experience in their use is essential to good design. Except for a few sizes of valve and die springs, there are very few springs manufactured for stock because of the infinite variety of characteristics involved. Utmost care in their design and manufacture and thorough analysis of service conditions are required for satisfactory performance.

20.1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this section is to describe the design methods used for each type of spring commonly used.

20.1.2 Scope

The data in this appendix are sufficient for general design purposes, and is not intended to include information for unusual designs or seldom used types of springs.

20.1.3 Abbreviations and Symbols

The following abbreviations and symbols are used throughout the appendix, unless otherwise noted:

- A = constant, for rectangular wire.
- B = constant, for rectangular wire.
- b = breadth or width, in.
- C = spring index = D/d .
- CL = compressed length, in.
- D = mean coil diameter, in.
- d = diameter of wire or side of square, in.
- E = modulus of elasticity in tension, psi.
- F = deflection, for N coils with load P , in.
- F° = deflection, for N coils, rotary, deg.
- FL = free length, unloaded spring, in.
- f = deflection, for one active coil, in., at load P .
- G = modulus of elasticity in torsion, psi.
- ID = inside diameter, in.

in. = inch.
 K = curvature stress-correction factor
 L = active length subject to deflection, in.
 l = length, in.
 lb = pound
 M = bending moment, in. lb.
 N = total active coils
 n' = vibration per minute.
 OD = outside diameter, in.
 P = load, lb.
 P_1 = applied load, lb (also P_2 , etc.)
 p = pitch, in.
 psi = pounds per square inch.
 R = distance from load to central axis, in.
 r = spring rate, load per in, lb/in.
 r_t = spring rate, inch lbs per deg. (Torsion springs).
 S_b = stress, bending, psi.
 S_t = stress, torsional, psi.
 $S_i t$ = stress, torsional, due to initial tension, psi.
 SH = solid height, in. (or SL = solid length).
 s = height, load is dropped, in.
 T = torque = $P \times R$, lb. in.
 TC = total coils.
 t = thickness, in.
 U = number of revolutions = $F^\circ / 360$
 W = weight, lb (also applied dynamic load).
 x = multiplied by
 Y = constant, for coned disc (Belleville) springs.
 Z_1 = constant, for coned disc (Belleville) springs.
 Z_2 = constant, for coned disc (Belleville) springs.
 α = alpha, angle of movement, deg.
 π = pi, 3.1416, in.
 σ = sigma, Poisson's ratio, 0.3 for steel

21. Compression Springs

21.1 Design Formulas

The design formulas in Table II are used in the design of helical compression and extension springs. Note that the same formulas apply to both types of springs. The formulas in Table III are for determining compression spring dimensions only.

21.2 Compression Spring Ends

Figure 3 illustrates the types of ends on compression springs. Their characteristics follow:

(a) Open Ends Not Ground;

also called Plain Ends, has the largest eccentricity of loading. These are used only when accuracy of loads is not important. This type is seldom used because such springs tangle severely during shipping.

(b) Closed Ends Not Ground;

also called squared ends, cost approximately the same as open end type and have less eccentricity. This type is often used on light wire springs under 1/32 in. dia wire and for heavier wire where the index exceeds 13.

(c) Open Ends Ground;

also called Plain Ends Ground, are seldom used as they cost about the same as the closed ends ground, but have high eccentricity of loading and tangle during shipping. They are sometimes used where the solid height is very limited and it is necessary to have as many active coils as possible in the least space.

(d) Closed Ends Ground;

also called Squared and Ground, is the most popular type as it provides a level seat and reduces the tendency to buckle. This is the most expensive type and should be avoided for springs made from very light wire. Each end coil is ground for 270° plus or minus 30° .

21.3 Diameter Changes In Compression Springs

When a helical compression spring is compressed an increase in the outside diameter occurs because the angularity of the coils changes so that it is nearly at a right angle to the axis. The outside diameter, when the spring is compressed solid, can be obtained from the following formula:

$$OD_c = \sqrt{D + \frac{p^2 - d^2}{\pi^2}} + d$$

In which:

OD_c = outside diameter at solid length

p = pitch, at free length

D = mean coil diameter at free length

d = wire diameter

21.4 Buckling

Compression springs having a free length greater than four (4) times their mean diameter become critical in lateral stability. When deflected beyond a certain percentage of the free length a spring will buckle. Figure 31 shows the maximum deflection which may be expected without buckling if the ends of the spring are closed and ground. Buckling can be reduced, space permitting, by a redesign using a heavier size wire and increasing the diameter of the coil. Buckling causes an undesirable reduction of the load and may cause early spring failure. If properly guided in a cylinder or over a rod, buckling can be reduced,

although friction against the guiding member will affect the load and shorten the spring life.

21.5 Direction of Helix

Unless functional requirement dictate a definite direction, the helix of compression and extension springs should be specified as optional. To prevent intermeshing of coils when springs operate one inside the other (see Figure 33), the helixes should be specified as opposite hand. For the same reason, springs which operate to slide freely over screw threads should have the helix specified opposite to that of the screw threads, but when a spring screws onto the threads of a screw or bolt, it should have the same helix as that of the screw or bolt.

21.6 Natural Frequency, Vibration and Surge

21.7 Impact

21.8 Spring Nests

21.9 Compression Spring Used As An Extension Spring

21.10 Spring Index (D/d)

21.11 Curvature Stress-Correction Factor (K)

In designing a spring it should be borne in mind that the total stress, as determined by this method, should not be used in calculating the deflection or number of coils. The torsional stress $S_t = PD/0.393d^3$ or $S_t = GdF/\pi ND^2$ should be utilized for such purposes.

21.12 Keystone Effect

When square wire and rectangular wire are coiled into springs, a change in shape occurs. This change takes place because some of the material on the outside diameter is drawn into the spring and the material on the inside diameter upsets, thereby changing the wire into a trapezoidal section. The original thickness of the wire is maintained at or near the mean diameter of the coil. It is necessary to take into account this upsetting of the material in determining the solid height of the spring. This dimensional change depends upon the spring index and the thickness of the material and may be determined by the following formula:

$$t' = 0.48t \left(\frac{OD}{D} + 1 \right)$$

where

t' = new thickness of inner edge after coiling

t = thickness before coiling

21.13 Constants for Rectangular Wire

21.14 Precautions and Suggestions for Effective Design

21.15 Tables of Spring Characteristics for Compression and Extension Springs

21.15.1 Example

22. Design Nomographs for Compression and Extension Springs

22.0.1 Example

23. Example of Compression Spring Calculation

23.0.1 Necessity for Several Calculations

Frequently the first set of calculations does not result in a satisfactory design for the conditions involved. It is usually necessary to make several sets of calculations before determining the final design. This often is caused by a stress that is too high, a difficult index for manufacture, or a length that would buckle and require support in a tube or over a rod.

24. Stranded Wire Helical Compression Springs

24.1 General

24.2 Stress

24.3 Formulas for 3 Stranded Wire Spring

$$P = \frac{Gd^4F}{2.54DN}$$

$$S_t = \frac{GdF}{\pi ND^2}$$

$$N = \frac{Gd^4F}{2.54PD^2}$$

$$r = \frac{P}{F}$$

22. Extension Springs

22.1 Deflection of Extension Spring Ends

Loading an extension spring having hook (loop) ends causes the hooks to deflect. The amount of this deflection depends on the type of hook used. For a half hook the deflection per hook is equivalent to .1 of a full coil and the total number of active coils for design

purposes will be $N + .2$. When a full hook is turned up from a full coil, the deflection per hook is equivalent to .5 of a full coil and the total number of active coils for design purposes will be $N + 1$.

22.2 Stresses in Hooks of Extension Springs

The hooks at the ends of extension springs are subjected to both tension (bending) and torsional stresses. See Figure 43. These combined stresses are frequently the limiting factor which determines the characteristics of the spring. These stresses occur at the base of the hooks and their magnitude is higher than the stress in the body. Therefore this is the weakest point in an extension spring and the stresses should be calculated. The allowable working stresses should not exceed those shown in the curves, Figure 62, Section II of this Appendix, if long life is required.

Bending Stress at Section A

$$S_b = \frac{PR}{.098d^3} \times \frac{r_1}{r_3}$$

Torsional Stress at Section A'

$$S_t = \frac{16PR}{\pi d^3} \times \frac{r_2}{r_4}$$

Where:

r_1 = Mean Radius of Hook, in.

r_2 = Mean Radius of Bend, in.

r_3 = Inside Radius of Hook, in.

r_4 = Inside Radius of Bend, in.

For best results the inside radius should be at least twice the wire diameter. Special ends can be used when high stresses occur in the hooks. By using a smaller diameter for the last few coils, see Figure 44, before the loop, the magnitude of PR is reduced. Thus the stress is reduced in direct proportion to the decrease in the magnitude of PR . By using as large radii for r_3 and r_4 as the design will permit the stress value is further reduced. The values of r_3 and r_4 can be determined by layout.

In extension springs with hooks bent off the body (see Figure 6, Off-set hook at side) the moment arm of the load on which the maximum torsion stress in the spring depends is about twice what it would be if the load were applied axially. This means doubling the stress for a given load.

22.3 Initial Tension

Initial tension is a load in pounds which opposes the opening of the coils by an external force. It is wound into the springs during the coiling operation. Extension springs will have a uniform rate after the applied load overcomes the load due to initial tension. The number of coils do not affect the amount of initial tension except when the weight of the coils is heavier than the initial tension. The amount of initial tension is dependent on the spring index (D/d); the smaller the index the larger the initial tension. Initial tension does not

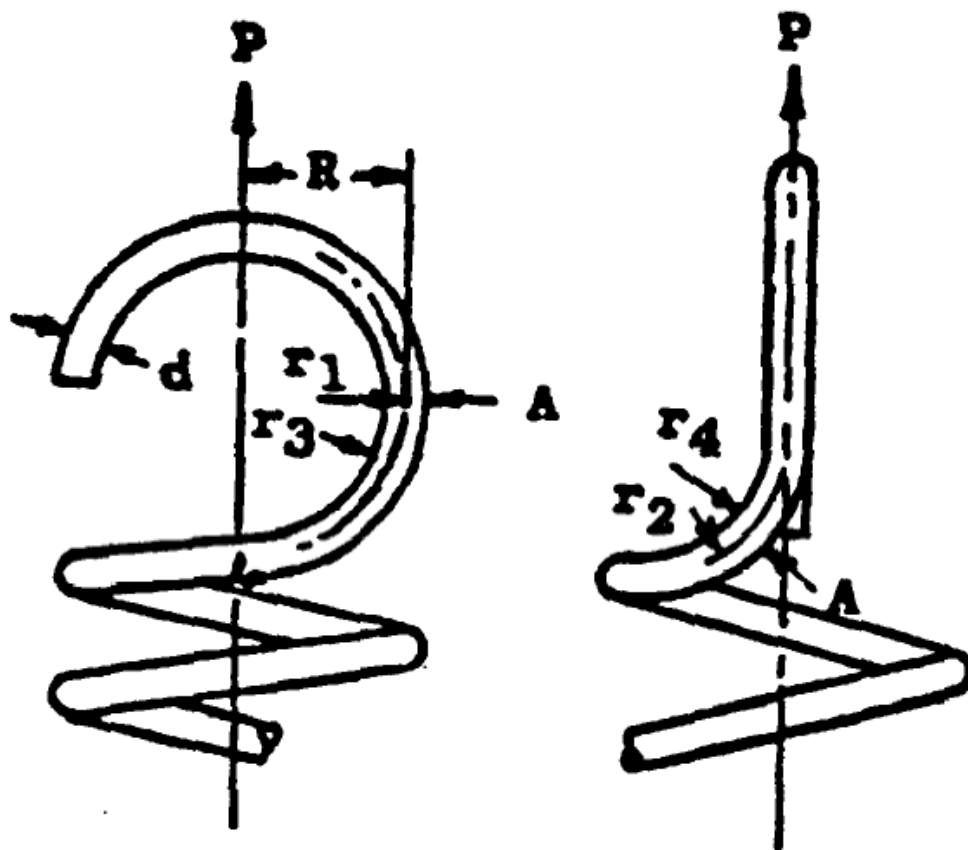


Figure 9:

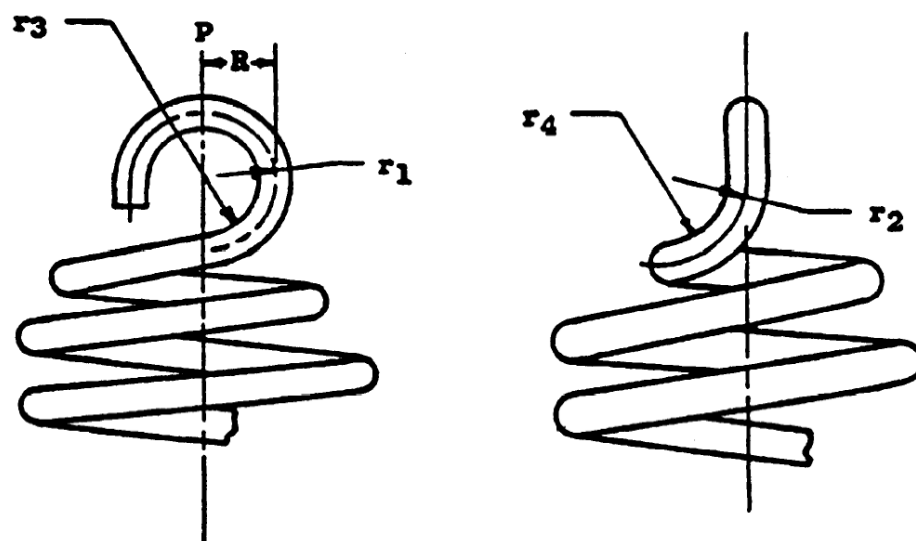


Figure 10:

increase the ultimate load or capacity of the spring but causes a larger portion thereof to be exerted during the initial deflection. For example, if the initial tension is 4 lbs and the spring rate is 9 lb then, at 1 inch deflection the load is

$$(1 \times 9) + 4 = 13\text{lb}$$

3-inches deflection the load is

$$(3 \times 9) + 4 = 31\text{lb}$$

In computing the total torsional stress add the torsional stress caused by initial tension to the torsional stress caused by deflection. Figure 45 shows the amount of initial tension in terms of torsional stress (without application of curvature stress correction factor) which can be coiled into extension springs made of music wire, oil tempered, corrosion resisting steel and hard drawn spring steels. Reduce these values 20 percent for springs made from nickel-base alloys such as Monel and Inconel. Hot rolled springs and those made of annealed materials cannot be wound with initial tension. Springs which require stress relieving will lose 25 to 50 percent of their initial tension. This loss can be compensated for during the coiling operation by winding more initial tension into the spring and thus obtain the required tension after stress relieving.

22.4 Example of Extension Spring Calculation

An extension spring is required to exert a force (load) of 27 lb at 2 in. deflection and be deflected an additional 3 in. (5 in. total) and then exert a total load of 55 lb. It must operate within a 1.812 in. minimum diameter bore.

Select a suitable oil tempered wire diameter and determine the number of coils, length over coils, free length inside ends, maximum extended length inside ends without set, stresses at all loads, etc., stressed for light service (see Figure 62).

(yet to be transcribed)

22.5 Precautions and Suggestions for Effective Design of Extension Springs

(a) Avoid using enlarged, extended, or specially shaped hooks or loops; they may double the cost of the spring and have high stress concentrations.

(b) If a plug must screw into the end of a spring, the spring should be coiled right hand.

(c) Nearly all extension springs are wound with enough initial tension to keep the spring together. Always figure on at least 5 to 10 percent of the final load as initial tension, unless otherwise specified.

(d) Electroplating does not deposit a good coating on the inside of, or between the coils of extension springs.

(e) Hooks on extension springs deflect under a load. Each half hook, made by bending one-half of a coil, deflects an amount equivalent to 0.1 of an active coil. Allowance for this deflection should be considered in design.

(f) If the relative position of the ends is not important note this fact on the drawing.

(g) For standard hooks keep the OD of the hook the same as the OD of the spring, and the distance from the end of the body, or from the last coil, to the inside of the hook about 75 to 85 percent of the ID of the spring.

(h) The body length or closed portion of an extension spring equals the number of coils in the body plus one, multiplied by the wire diameter.

(i) When deflected $1 \frac{1}{4}$ times the maximum deflection as assembled, the total stress should be less than the Minimum Elastic Limit shown by the curves in Figure 62, as modified by their multiplying constants.

22.6 Garter Springs

22.6.1 General

Close coiled extension springs used in the form of rings by connecting the ends are often used as driving belts, for oil seals and as retainers. The ends may have half or full loops and then be hooked together or one end may be reduced in diameter for three to six coils and screwed into the other end. Connecting the ends with a separate short section, called a connector, is occasionally done.

22.7 Formulas

(yet to be transcribed)

22.8 Example of Calculation

(yet to be transcribed)

23. Torsion Springs

23.1 Design Formulas

(yet to be transcribed)

23.2 Stresses in Torsion Spring Ends

(yet to be transcribed)

23.3 Deflection of Torsion Spring Ends

(yet to be transcribed)

23.4 Change in Diameter and Length

(yet to be transcribed)

23.5 Helix

(yet to be transcribed)

23.6 Design Nomographs for Helical Torsion Springs

(yet to be transcribed)

23.7 Moment vs. Wire Size Chart

(yet to be transcribed)

23.8 Torsion Spring Calculation

(yet to be transcribed)

23.8.1 Example of Calculation

(yet to be transcribed)

23.9 Precautions and Suggestions for Effective Design

(yet to be transcribed)

24. Spiral Torsion Springs

(yet to be transcribed)

24.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

24.2 Stress

(yet to be transcribed)

24.3 Ends

(yet to be transcribed)

25. Constant Force Springs

25.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

25.2 Materials

(yet to be transcribed)

25.3 Inner Ends

(yet to be transcribed)

25.4 Outer Ends

(yet to be transcribed)

25.5 Multiple Mounting

(yet to be transcribed)

25.6 Stress Factor

(yet to be transcribed)

25.7 Extension Type

(yet to be transcribed)

25.8 Formulas

(yet to be transcribed)

25.9 Simplified Design

(yet to be transcribed)

25.10 Design Charts

(yet to be transcribed)

25.11 Example

(yet to be transcribed)

26. Flat Springs

26.1 Design

(yet to be transcribed)

26.2 Stress

(yet to be transcribed)

27. Coned Disc (Belleville) Springs

27.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

27.2 Load Deflection

(yet to be transcribed)

27.3 Stress

(yet to be transcribed)

27.4 Loads

(yet to be transcribed)

28. Recommended Maximum Working Stresses

28.1 Fatigue Strength Curves

(yet to be transcribed)

28.1.1 Light Service

(yet to be transcribed)

28.1.2 Average Service

(yet to be transcribed)

28.1.3 Severe Service

(yet to be transcribed)

28.1.4 Other Materials

(yet to be transcribed)

28.2 Permissible Elevated Temperatures

(yet to be transcribed)

Appendix A, Section III

30. Spring Manufacture

30.1 General

(yet to be transcribed)

31. Stress Relieving

(yet to be transcribed)

32. Cold Set to Solid

(yet to be transcribed)

33. Grinding

(yet to be transcribed)

34. Shot Peening

(yet to be transcribed)

35. Protective Coatings

(yet to be transcribed)

36. Hydrogen Embrittlement

(yet to be transcribed)

37. Tolerances for Springs

37.1 Tolerance on Loads

The recommended tolerance on all loads is plus or minus 10 per cent and should be specified as shown on the drawing requirement charts. However, when the deflection from the free length to the limit load is small, the load tolerance must be large and should be considered proportional to the tolerances that apply to the free length. For example, if the deflection is only $\frac{1}{16}$ inch and the tolerance on the free length is $\pm \frac{1}{16}$ inch, then it follows that the tolerance on the first load should be plus or minus 8 per cent (= 8 per cent of $\frac{1}{16}$)? otherwise the tolerance on the free length could not be taken.

Where a specific amount of initial tension is required for extension springs, it should be specified in pounds or ounces with a recommended tolerance of plus or minus 15 per cent, but it usually is specified as a REFERENCE.

Smaller load tolerances than these usually require testing and adjusting each spring and add considerably to the manufacturing time and to the cost.

Table XXIII. Causes of spring failure. Listed in sequence according to frequency of failure.

Spring failure may be caused by breakage, high permanent set or loss of load. Group I lists the causes that occur most frequently. Group II contains the less frequent causes and Group III lists causes that occur occasionally.

Group I:

HIGH STRESS

The majority of spring failures are due to high stresses caused by large deflections and high loads. High stresses should be used only for statically loaded springs. Low stresses lengthen fatigue life.

HYDROGEN EMBRITTLEMENT

Improper electro-plating methods and acid cleaning of springs, without proper baking treatment, cause spring steels to become brittle, and is a frequent cause of failure. Non-ferrous springs are immune.

SHARP BENDS & HOLES

Sharp bends on extension, torsion and flat springs and holes or notches in flat springs cause high concentration of stress resulting in failure. Bend radii should be as large as possible, and tool marks avoided.

FATIGUE

Repeated deflections of springs, especially above 1,000,000 operations, even with medium stresses, may cause failure. Low stresses should be used for severe operating conditions.

Group II:

SHOCK LOADING

Impact, shock, and rapid loading cause far higher stresses than those computed by the regular spring formulas. High carbon spring steels do not withstand shock loading as well as alloy steels.

CORROSION

Slight rusting or pitting caused by acids, alkali, galvanic corrosion, stress corrosion cracking, or corrosive atmosphere weakens the material and causes higher stresses in the corroded area.

FAULTY HEAT TREATMENT

Keeping spring materials at the hardening temperature for longer periods than necessary causes an undesirable growth in grain structure resulting in brittleness even though the hardness may be correct.

FAULTY MATERIAL

Poor material containing inclusions, seams, slivers, and flat material with rough, slit or torn edges causes early failure. Overdrawn wire, improper hardness, and poor grain structure also result in early failure.

Group III:

HIGH TEMPERATURE

High temperatures reduce spring temper (or hardness), lowers the modulus of elasticity thereby causing lower loads, reduces the elastic limit and increases corrosion. Corrosion resisting or nickel alloys should be used.

LOW TEMPERATURE

Temperatures below -40° F lessen the ability of carbon steels to withstand shock loads. Carbon steels become brittle at -70° F. Corrosion resisting, nickel or nonferrous alloys should be used.

FRICTION

Close fits on rods or in holes results in a wearing away of material and occasional failure. The outside diameters of compression springs expand during deflection but they become smaller on torsion springs.

OTHER CAUSES

Enlarged hooks on extension springs increases the stress at the bends. Carrying too much electrical current will cause failure. Welding and soldering frequently destroy the spring temper. Tool marks, nicks, and cuts often became stress raisers. Deflecting torsion springs outwardly causes high stresses. Winding them tightly causes binding on supporting rods. High speed of deflection, vibration and surging due to operation near natural periods of vibration or their harmonics, cause increased stresses.